support from Dogra landowners, who were part of the ruling class under the erstwhile Maharaja's reign, but who now felt threatened by land reforms. In Jammu and Kashmir, 'deep-seated communal differences lay just below the surface of party-politics'. The Praja Parishad's agitation, organised around the slogan '*Ek Vidhan, Ek Nishan, Ek Pradhan*' (One Constitution, One Symbol, One Premier), gained momentum when three Hindu nationalist parties—the Jan Sangh, the Hindu Mahasabha and the Ram Rajya Parishad—decided to back it. The Kashmir agitation became a key Jan Sangh priority after the 1952 general election. Syama Prasad Mookerjee's arrest in Kashmir and his mysterious death on 24 June 1953 while in police custody ended the agitation.[83] But it only served to underscore the centrality of the Kashmir question for the Jan Sangh's politics.

On 25 January 1954, the Jan Sangh demanded the full integration of Kashmir into the Indian Union. Its CWC passed another resolution on this in Bombay, titled 'Integrate Kashmir', saying that 'any continuance of the present uncertainty about Kashmir under Article 370 is undesirable'. In the Jan Sangh's view, only S.P. Mookerjee's death and the Jan Sangh's agitation saved India 'from second dismemberment' and 'rarely has history vindicated a stand in so short a period and in so unequivocal a manner'.[84] By 1955, it was demanding, as its CWC did in Jodhpur, 'This State should be completely merged with India and fully brought on the level of other States. All the remaining Fundamental Rights of Indian citizens should be extended to the citizens of Kashmir and the National Flag of India should be honoured in the State as the highest flag and not on the same level with the State flag of Kashmir.'[85]

The Jan Sangh passed resolution after resolution on the integration of Kashmir, right up to 1960. In 1958, at Delhi, it concluded that, while the writ of the Indian state should extend to all parts of Kashmir, 'abolition of permit system and all such discriminations between the citizens of the state and those of the rest of India are some of the essential steps that need to be taken in this connection …'[86] This is exactly what Narendra Modi and Amit Shah did on 5 August 2019. Narendra Modi, after all, had accompanied the then BJP president Murali Manohar Joshi on his